

The configurator pattern, applied to the *OTC benefit*.

Medicare Advantage members leave **billions in over-the-counter dollars unspent every year** — not because they don't want the products, but because the benefit is unnavigable. We didn't invent a fix. **We ported a proven supply-chain pattern to a market no one has solved.**

1 PROVEN PATTERN, NOT A NEW IDEA

CONFIGURATION, NOT CURATION

The Dell / CPQ builder

You don't pick a motherboard and a power supply. You state how you'll use the machine, and the system assembles a **valid, compatible build** — guaranteeing the parts work together. Configure-Price-Quote engines have run this playbook for decades.

The system carries the expertise. The buyer only brings their need.

ONE PRODUCT, MANY SKUS

UNSPSC & GTIN standards

Global supply chains collapse duplicate products from every supplier into one **canonical entry**, then map each vendor's code beneath it — a 20-year-old GS1 standard.

Documented case: **15 variants of one valve** → **3 canonical entries**, cutting carrying cost on contact.

2 WHY THE OTC BENEFIT BREAKS TODAY

Buried benefit

The allowance is hidden in an Evidence-of-Coverage PDF. Members often don't know it exists or that funds reset quarterly.

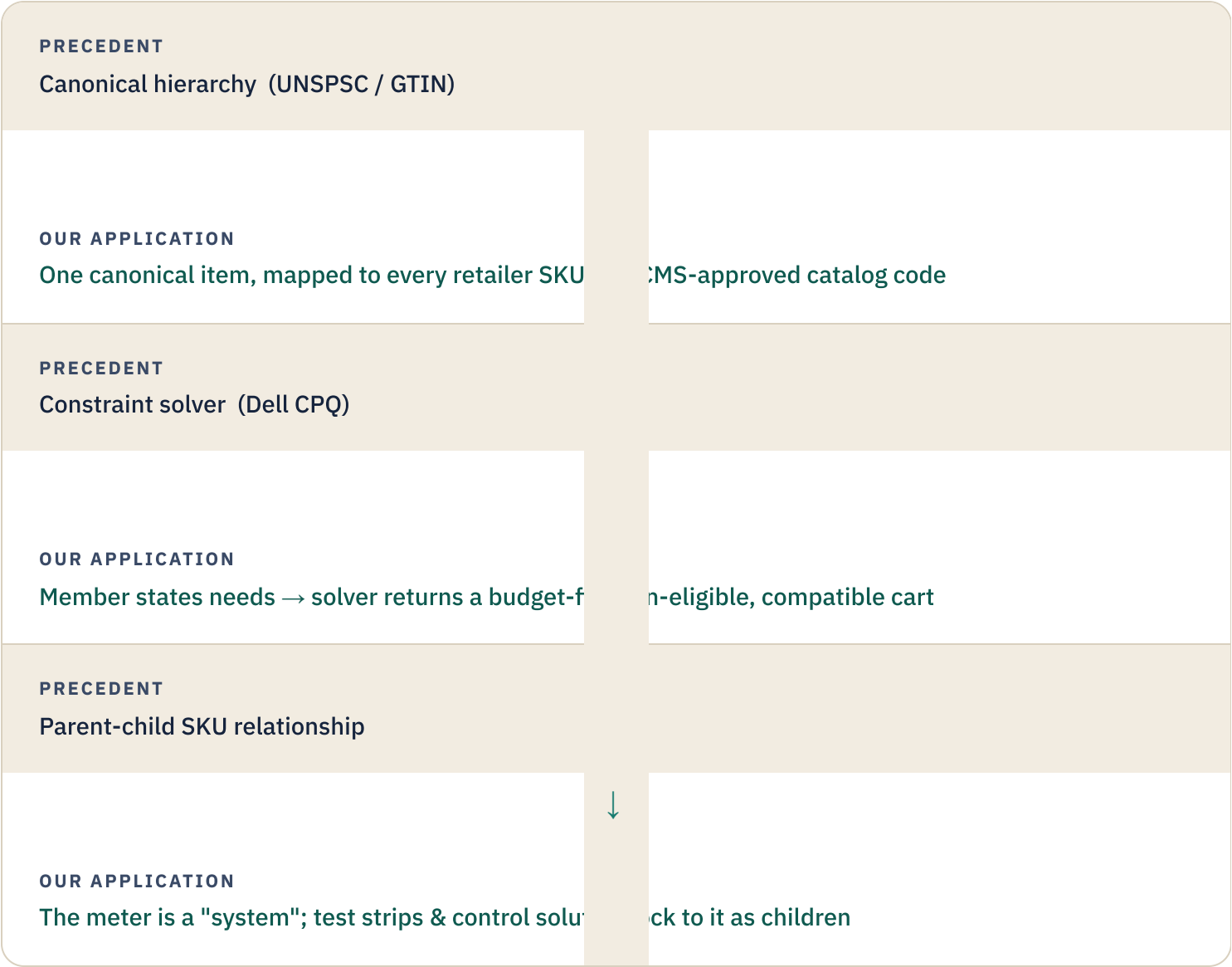
SKU chaos

The same product carries different codes across Walmart, CVS, Medline, and the NationsOTC / OTCHS catalogs. No shared language.

Navigation burden

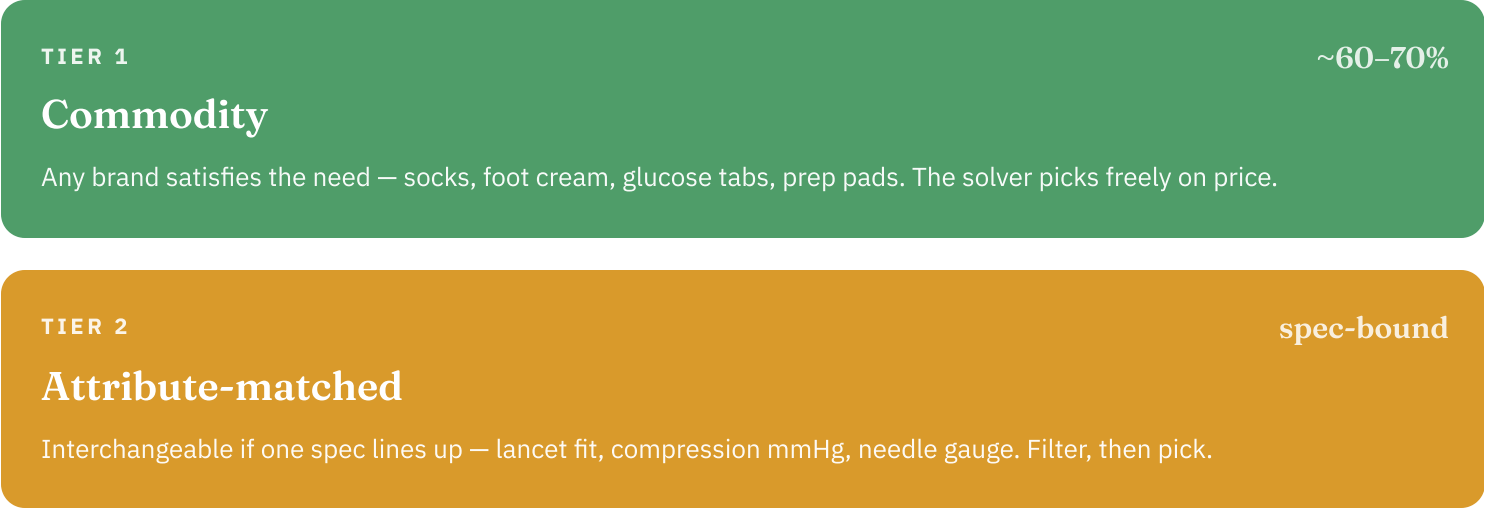
Roughly 1 in 4 Americans over 65 don't use the internet — and frankly, none of us know exactly what to buy. The cognitive load kills utilization.

3 HOW HEALTHBENEFITS.SHOP APPLIES IT



4

THE ENGINE: SUBSTITUTABILITY TIERS



TIER 3

locked

System-locked

Must match a parent device. Strips & control solution travel with the meter as one unit.

5 THE CONFIGURATOR AS A CONSTRAINT SOLVER

INPUTS

- Member's selected needs
- Quarterly allowance
- Their plan's eligible catalog

CONSTRAINTS

- Eligibility (CMS-approved)
- Compatibility (meter ↔ strips)
- Budget (allowance cap)

OUTPUT

- A complete, valid cart
- Remaining balance
- Headroom to spend down

Budget rule: price each item as a range. Build against the **ceiling** for a **guaranteed-fit** promise on any catalog; track the **floor** to chase **utilization** — because unused dollars don't roll over.

6 WHY IT COMPOUNDS

Utilization ↑



Outcomes ↑



Star ratings ↑



Plan revenue ↑



Reinvest in members

70%+

of Medicare Advantage plans
now offer an OTC benefit

25M+

members with access — a top-3
most-used supplemental
benefit

\$0

rolls over — every unspent
quarter is a missed outcome
and a missed star credit

healthbenefits.shop

Canonical hierarchy + configurator · Strategy brief